

ClamAV vulnerability on Ubuntu gets fixed

A ClamAV vulnerability was detected in Ubuntu 14.10, Ubuntu 14.04 LTS and Ubuntu 12.04 LTS operating systems, and it has been fixed now. Details about the vulnerability have been shared by Canonical in a security notice.

Canonical has confirmed that the ClamAV vulnerability had the capability to crash or run a program, if it got processed with a specially crafted file. Though this is not a major issue, developers still went ahead and fixed it anyhow. Following the patch, users are now advised to upgrade their systems as soon as possible.

As published on the security notice, "Sebastian Andrzej Siewior discovered that ClamAV incorrectly handled certain *upack* packer files. An attacker could possibly use this issue to cause ClamAV to crash, resulting in a denial of service, or possibly execute arbitrary code." If you are interested to know more about the security issue you can refer to the security notification by Canonical.

As soon as the systems are upgraded, all the security loopholes will be fixed and the system will get the latest ClamAV package, specifically designed for each distribution. Run the *Update Manager* application in order to apply the update. A system update usually makes all the necessary changes. Canonical has also explained that rebooting the system is not required to finish this updating process but if the application is already running, then it's recommended that you restart it.



Linux 3.19 kernel released

Finally, Linux 3.19 kernel is available officially. On the scheduled day of its release, February 8, 2015, Linux 3.19 kernel got tagged on Git. Surprisingly, Linux founder Linus Torvalds didn't issue any official announcement along with the release.

The most important and notable features and changes in Linux 3.19 are as follows:

- The AMDKFD driver is getting launched, thereby making open source AMD HSA almost a reality.
- Intel's next-generation Skylake graphics is supported now.
- DPM fan control is supported within the Radeon driver.
- NVIDIA GeForce 900 series driver is supported.

The Linux 3.20 kernel is slated to come on board next.

openSUSE 12.3 officially expires!

openSUSE 12.3 was released in 2013, and now this version is to be discontinued. Developers have decided that it's time to declare that openSUSE 12.3 has reached the end of its life.

It has not been too long since this openSUSE version was launched, though. But in line with the trend seen with other Linux based operating systems, two years is actually much more than usual. As these operating systems come for free, users should remember that maintaining any of them is quite a time consuming affair. Also, they become irrelevant gradually as better and upgraded versions of the same operating system keep getting released by the same developers. Hence, investing time on an older version doesn't make much sense.

openSUSE group member Benjamin Brunner announced in his mailing list, "With the release of Flash-player on January 29, 2015, the SUSE sponsored maintenance of openSUSE 12.3 has ended. openSUSE 12.3 is now officially discontinued and out of support by SUSE. openSUSE 12.3 was released on March 13, 2013, making it ca. 11 months of security and bug-fix support."

So users are advised to upgrade their operating systems as soon as possible to the latest openSUSE 13.2.

Microsoft gets friendlier with open source; releases CoreCLR on GitHub

The courtship between Microsoft and the open source community has just grown stronger with the announcement that CoreCLR has also been open sourced on GitHub.

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